

Alex Giménez Romero

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Summary

My research is highly interdisciplinary, situated at the intersection of complex systems science and ecology. As a physicist by training, I integrate rigorous mathematical principles with the complexities of biological systems, collaborating closely with experts in ecology and biology to devise robust mathematical and computational solutions for diverse ecological problems. During my PhD at IFISC, I have developed theoretical and data-driven models to address pressing ecological challenges associated with biodiversity loss due to anthropogenic pressures, including the spread of emergent diseases, ocean acidification, and the degradation of vital coastal ecosystems, such as coral reefs and seagrass meadows. The development and analysis of these models involved mastery of different techniques, including compartmental models based on differential equations, stochastic and spatially explicit individual-based models, artificial intelligence (both supervised and unsupervised learning but especially deep learning), climate and satellite data management, etc. Recently, after a research stay at the University of Oxford, my interests have broadened to encompass theoretical ecology more generally.

I have published 11 SCI papers in journals such as *Communications Biology*, *Global Ecology and Biogeography*, *Proceedings of the Royal Society B* or *Scientific Reports* (7 first author, 3 second author and 1 last author. 5-D1, 6-Q1). I have also written 1 technical report for public administrations and 3 popular science papers. I currently have 4 papers submitted to international journals and available as public preprints in bioRxiv and EcoEvoRxiv. My research is built upon extensive international collaborations with leading institutions, including the University of Oxford, Utah State University, University of Exeter and the King Abdullah University of Science and Technology (KAUST). These collaborations have enabled me to work alongside renowned researchers, such as Prof. Duarte and Prof. Salguero-Gómez, fostering interdisciplinary approaches to address complex ecological challenges. I have presented my research at numerous national and international conferences, including invitations to speak at symposia in Lisbon and Seoul. Additionally, I delivered an applied math seminar at the Utah State University, a lab-wide seminar at the University of Oxford and a workshop at KAUST, sharing my work with diverse academic audiences. My research has garnered significant attention, including highlights by CSIC and coverage in Science ("In Other Journals"), as well as broader recognition in the media through multiple press features. I am also dedicated to public outreach, having authored three articles for The Conversation, contributed to a short documentary for IB3-TV, and participating in dissemination events, such as Pint of Science, ensuring that my work resonates beyond the academic community.

I have completed 4 months of stays in international institutions hosted by researchers of international reputation, such as Prof. Bebbier (Exeter) and Prof. Salguero-Gómez (Oxford). I have taught undergraduate and master's subjects at the University of the Balearic Islands (UIB) and I have co-directed 2 master's theses. I am currently co-supervising 1 master thesis and 1 PhD student. I am a reviewer of 4 international scientific journals (PLOS Computational Biology, Conservation Biology, Scientific Reports, Ecological Modelling) and a scientific conference (JuliaCon).

Experience

- 2025 –  **Postdoctoral researcher**, Center for Advanced Studies of Blanes
Under the supervision of Meritxell Genovart.
-  **Assistant Professor**, University of Girona – Physics Department
Fundamentals of Materials Science for engineering degrees

Experience (continued)

- 2022 – 2025  **Research Assistant**, Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems
Under the supervision of Manuel A. Matías.
- 2024 – 3 mo  **Research Stay**, Oxford University
Under the supervision of Roberto Salguero-Gómez.
- 2023 – 1 mo  **Remote Research Stay**, University of Exeter
Under the supervision of Daniel P. Bebber.
-  **Research Stay**, Institute of Physics of Cantabria
Under the supervision of Jose M. Gutiérrez.
- 2021 – 2022  **Research Assistant**, Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems
Competitive internal call from MdM program. Under the supervision of Manuel A. Matías.
- 2020 – 2021  **Research Assistant**, Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems
Under the supervision of Manuel A. Matías.
- 2019 – 2019  **Research Internship**, Institute of Material Science of Barcelona

Education

- 2021 – 2024  **PhD in Physics of Complex Systems**, University of the Balearic Islands
Thesis title: *Theoretical and data-driven models in Ecology*
Distinction “cum laude”
- 2021 – 2022  **M.Sc. Quantitative Finances**, UNED
Excellent in all modules.
Thesis title: *A robust analysis of mean-variance and higher moment portfolio optimization models.*
- 2019 – 2020  **M.Sc. Physics of Complex Systems**, University of the Balearic Islands
Excellent in 9/13 subjects.
Thesis title: *Modelling the Mass Mortality Event of Pinna nobilis.*
- 2015 – 2019  **B.Sc. Physics**, Autonomous University of Barcelona
Honors in numerical methods I and II
Thesis title: *Nanoscale Heat Transport Study by Monte Carlo Simulations.*

Research Publications

Preprints

-  **À. Giménez-Romero**, C. Hernández, M. Genovart, and R. Salguero-Gómez, “Population structure plays a key role in community stability,” *EcoEvoRxiv*, 2025, (2n round revision Ecology Letters).  DOI: [10.32942/X2661X](https://doi.org/10.32942/X2661X).
-  E. Mayol, P. A. Aramburu, C. A. M. Lujan-Williams, *et al.*, “Effects of moderate meadow fragmentation and hydrodynamics on the water column oxygenation by the seagrass *Posidonia oceanica*,” *submitted to Limnology and Oceanography*, 2025.
-  **À. Giménez-Romero**, D. Ferchichi, P. Moreno-Spiegelberg, T. Sintes, and M. A. Matías, “Mapping the distribution of seagrass meadows from space with deep convolutional neural networks,” *bioRxiv*, 2024.  DOI: [10.1101/2024.03.21.586047](https://doi.org/10.1101/2024.03.21.586047).

Journal Articles

-  **À. Giménez-Romero**, E. Moralejo, and M. A. Matías, “High-resolution climate data reveals increased risk of pierce’s disease for grapevines worldwide,” *Scientific Reports*, vol. 15, p. 31 282, 2025.  DOI: [10.1038/s41598-025-13994-1](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-025-13994-1).

- 2 E. Moralejo, J. A. García-Muñoz, S. Denman, and À. **Giménez-Romero**, “Leaf susceptibility of macaronesian laurel forest species to phytophthora ramorum,” *European Journal of Forest Research*, 2025.  DOI: [10.1007/s10342-025-01764-7](https://doi.org/10.1007/s10342-025-01764-7).
- 3 À. **Giménez-Romero**, M. Iturbide, E. Moralejo, J. M. Gutiérrez, and M. A. Matías, “Global warming significantly increases the risk of pierce’s disease epidemics in european vineyards,” *Scientific Reports*, vol. 14, p. 9648, 2024.  DOI: [10.1038/s41598-024-59947-y](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-024-59947-y).
- 4 À. **Giménez-Romero**, M. A. Matías, and C. M. Duarte, “Unravelling the universal spatial properties of coral reefs,” *Global Ecology and Biogeography*, e13939, 2024.  DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1111/geb.13939>.
- 5 E. Moralejo, À. **Giménez-Romero**, and M. A. Matías, “Linking intercontinental biogeographic events to decipher how european vineyards escaped pierce’s disease,” *Proceedings of the Royal Society B: Biological Sciences*, vol. 291, p. 20 241 130, 2024.  DOI: [10.1098/rspb.2024.1130](https://doi.org/10.1098/rspb.2024.1130).
- 6 À. **Giménez-Romero**, E. Moralejo, and M. A. Matías, “A compartmental model for xylella fastidiosa diseases with explicit vector seasonal dynamics,” *Phytopathology*®, vol. 113, pp. 1686–1696, 2023.  DOI: [10.1094/PHYTO-11-22-0428-V](https://doi.org/10.1094/PHYTO-11-22-0428-V).
- 7 C. Lago, À. **Giménez-Romero**, M. Morente, M. A. Matías, A. Moreno, and A. Fereres, “Degree-day-based model to predict egg hatching of Philaenus spumarius (Hemiptera: Aphrophoridae), the main vector of Xylella fastidiosa in Europe,” *Environmental Entomology*, vol. 52, pp. 350–359, 2023.  DOI: [10.1093/ee/nvad013](https://doi.org/10.1093/ee/nvad013).
- 8 S. Flecha, À. **Giménez-Romero**, J. Tintoré, *et al.*, “Ph trends and seasonal cycle in the coastal balearic sea reconstructed through machine learning,” *Scientific Reports*, vol. 12, p. 12 956, 2022.  DOI: [10.1038/s41598-022-17253-5](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-022-17253-5).
- 9 A. **Giménez-Romero**, J. Galván, M. Montesinos, *et al.*, “Global predictions for the risk of establishment of pierce’s disease of grapevines,” *Communications Biology*, vol. 5, p. 1389, 2022.  DOI: [10.1038/s42003-022-04358-w](https://doi.org/10.1038/s42003-022-04358-w).
- 10 À. **Giménez-Romero**, R. Flaquer-Galmés, and M. A. Matías, “Vector-borne diseases with nonstationary vector populations: The case of growing and decaying populations,” *Phys. Rev. E*, vol. 106, p. 054 402, 5 2022.  DOI: [10.1103/PhysRevE.106.054402](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevE.106.054402).
- 11 À. **Giménez-Romero**, F. Vazquez, C. López, and M. A. Matías, “Spatial effects in parasite-induced marine diseases of immobile hosts,” *Royal Society Open Science*, vol. 9, p. 212 023, 2022.  DOI: [10.1098/rsos.212023](https://doi.org/10.1098/rsos.212023).
- 12 À. **Giménez-Romero**, A. Grau, I. E. Hendriks, and M. A. Matias, “Modelling parasite-produced marine diseases: The case of the mass mortality event of pinna nobilis,” *Ecological Modelling*, vol. 459, p. 109 705, 2021.  DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecolmodel.2021.109705>.

Technical Reports

- 1 D. P. Bebbier, S. J. Gurr, A. Karley, L. Lozada-Ellison, T. Beale, and À. **Giménez-Romero**, “Interdisciplinary analysis of plant health threats to scotland: Project final report,” Scotland’s Centre of Expertise for Plant Health (PHC), Tech. Rep., 2024.  DOI: [10.5281/zenodo.11613888](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11613888).

Presentations

8 oral presentations in international conferences (2 invited), 4 oral presentations in national conferences and 11 poster presentations.

Presentations (continued)

Invited talks

- 2024  **Minisymposium.** Korean Society for Mathematical Biology (KSMB), *Modeling the risk of vector-borne plant diseases in a changing climate.*
-  **Minisymposium.** Dynamical Systems Applied to Biology and Natural Sciences (DSABNS), *Modelling Xylella fastidiosa diseases: transmission dynamics, global spatiotemporal risk predictions and design of control strategies.*

Contributed talks

- 2025  **FisES.** Universidad de Santiago de Compostela, *Population structure plays a key role in community stability.*
-  **SIBECOL & AEET Meeting.** Pontevedra, *Population structure plays a key role in community stability.*
- 2024  **Annual Meeting of the British Ecological Society.** ACC Liverpool, *Population structure is key to community stability.*
-  **FisEs Joven.** Online, *Population structure plays a key role in ecosystem stability.*
-  **Conference on Complex Systems.** University of Exeter, *Universal spatial properties of coral reefs.*
-  **Climate-Inclusive Ecosystem Modelling: Understanding the Dynamics of Ecosystems in a Changing World (ECM satellite).** Centre de Recerca Matemàtica (CRM), *A climate-driven epidemiological model for Xylella fastidiosa diseases.*
- 2023  **Conferencia Internacional sobre Xylella fastidiosa.** Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas (CSIC), *Modeling Xf diseases: transmission dynamics, global spatiotemporal risk predictions and design of control strategies.*
-  **FisEs Joven.** Online, *Vector-borne diseases with non-stationary vector populations.*
- 2022  **Congreso de la Sociedad Española de Fitopatología.** Universidad Politécnica de Valencia (UPV), *Global Risk Predictions for Pierce's Disease of Grapevines.*
-  **Conference on Complex Systems.** Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems (IFISC), *Global Risk Predictions for Pierce's Disease of Grapevines.*
-  **International Symposium of Plant Virus Epidemiology.** Instituto de Ciencias Agrarias (ICA), *Global Risk Predictions for Pierce's Disease of Grapevines.*
- 2021  **3rd European conference on Xylella fastidiosa.** European Food Safe Authority (EFSA) *Risk of establishment of Pierce's disease in main wine-producer regions worldwide.*

Seminars

- 2024  **SalGo team seminar.** Oxford University, *Population structure plays a key role in community stability.*
- 2023  **Las Mañanas IFCA.** Instituto de Física de Cantabria (IFCA), *A climate-driven epidemiological model for Pierce's disease of grapevines.*
- 2022  **Applied Math Seminar.** Utah State University (USU), *Modelling Parasite-Produced Marine Diseases: spatial vs non-spatial models.*

Research projects

- 2023 – 2026  **María de Maeztu Unit of Excellence.** Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems (IFISC). **PI:** Claudio Mirasso and Ingo Fisher.

Research projects (continued)

- 2022 – 2025  CYCLE (*Complex DYnamics of CoastAL Ecosystems: Resilience to Climate Change*). Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems (IFISC). **PI:** Tomàs Sintes, Damià Gomila and Iris Hendriks.
- 2022 – 2024  SEDIMENT (*SEagrass DIversity in the MEditerranean basin in a global change scenario: a machine learNing approach from saTellite images*). Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems (IFISC). **PI:** Tomàs Sintes and Manuel Matías.
- 2019 – 2022  SuMaEco (*Sustainability of marine coastal ecosystems in the context of global change in the Mediterranean Sea*). Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems (IFISC). **PI:** Damià Gomila, Tomàs Sintes and Núria Marbà.
- 2018 – 2022  María de Maeztu Unit of Excellence. Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems (IFISC). **PI:** Claudio Mirasso and Ingo Fisher.

Funding

- 2025  **Postdoctoral Fellowship** – Juan de la Cierva. 76.600€
Grant to perform a 2 year postdoc at CEAB-CSIC under the supervision of Daniel Oro.
- 2024  **Research stay** – IMOVE CSIC. 4.500€
Grant to perform a 3 month stay at Oxford University under the supervision of Rob Salguero-Gómez.
-  **Research stay** – Ayudas CEP-EDUIB-Santander. 4.000€
Grant to perform a 3 month stay at Oxford University under the supervision of Rob Salguero-Gómez. (*Declined*)

Press releases

- 2025  *Un latido oculto en el arrecife: dos modelos revelan cómo crecen y resisten los corales ante la crisis climática* – elDiario
-  *Un estudio sugiere que el cambio climático abre la puerta a una enfermedad de la vid que Europa esquivó hace 150 años* – CSIC, Phytoma
-  *Entrevista Arran de Mar* – Tarragona Ràdio
- 2024  *Un estudio revela patrones espaciales universales en corales de todo el mundo* – La Vanguardia, yahoo!noticias
-  *The absence of an epidemic in grapes* – In Other Journals (Science)
-  *El cambio climático potencia la bacteria que devora olivos en el Mediterráneo* – CSIC, ABC, RTVE, El Periódico, La Sexta, 20 minutos, EuropaPress, Última Hora, Diario de Mallorca...
-  *El 'ébola del olivo' podría llevar casi una década en Mallorca* – Última Hora.
-  *Capítol 555* – IB3 Mèteo.
-  *La intel·ligència artificial, una eina al servei de la posidònia* – IB3 Notícies.
- 2023  *Una nueva herramienta permite predecir la eclosión de las ninfas del insecto que transmite la Xylella* – SER Ibiza, IB3 Ràdio.
- 2022  *Un equipo del CSIC identifica la tendencia de acidificación del Mar Balear a través de inteligencia artificial* – CSIC, La Vanguardia, 20minutos, COPE, EuropaPress, Última Hora, Diario de Mallorca, Ara Balears.
-  *El IFISC desarrolla un modelo para entender las epidemias marinas* – Última Hora.

Teaching

- 2024 – 2025  **Fundamentals of Material Science** – University of Girona
B.Sc. in Engineering (several).
- 2023 – 2024  **Complex Systems Modelling in Economics** – University of the Balearic Islands
M.Sc. in Physics of Complex Systems. *Lecturer: Dr. Pere Colet & Dr. Rosa López*
-  **Econophysics** – University of the Balearic Islands
4th year of B.Sc. in Physics. *Lecturer: Dr. Pere Colet & Dr. Rosa López*
- 2022 – 2023  **Econophysics** – University of the Balearic Islands
4th year of B.Sc. in Physics. *Lecturer: Dr. Rosa López*

Thesis Supervision

- 2025 –  **PhD Thesis** – University of the Balearic Islands – Juan Carlos Cabanillas
The influence of climate on the dynamics of vector-borne epidemics: the case of *Xylella fastidiosa*. *co-supervised with Dr. Manuel A. Matías*
- 2023 – 2025  **M.Sc. Thesis** – University of the Balearic Islands – Elena del Campo
Monitoring the resilience of seagrass meadows from satellite imagery using machine learning. *co-supervised with Dr. Manuel A. Matías*
- 2022 – 2023  **M.Sc. Thesis** – University of the Balearic Islands – Mustapha Bousakla
Age of infection disease modeling: from Kermack and McKendrick to multi-compartment models. *co-supervised with Dr. Manuel A. Matías*
- 2020 – 2021  **M.Sc. Thesis** – University of the Balearic Islands – Rosa Flaquer
A compartmental model for vector transmitted diseases: an application to *Xylella fastidiosa*. *co-supervised with Dr. Manuel A. Matías*

Mentoring

- 2024  **Cientific@s en prácticas** – Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems.
Descifrando el fondo marino desde el espacio.
- 2023  **SURF fellowship** – Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems
Compartmental models and their application to study phytopathologies. *co-supervised with Dr. Manuel A. Matías*
- 2022  **SURF fellowship** – Institute for Cross-disciplinary Physics and Complex Systems
Analysis of biodiversity in Posidonia meadows with satellite images through machine learning. *co-supervised with Dr. Manuel A. Matías*

Outreach

Articles

- 2024  **The Conversation** (Medioambiente + Energía). *Cómo los viñedos europeos escaparon de una devastadora enfermedad... por ahora*
-  **The Conversation** (Medioambiente + Energía). *“Xylella fastidiosa” y el cambio climático amenazan la viticultura europea: hemos calculado cuánto*
- 2023  **The Conversation** (Ciencia + Tecnología). *Descifrando el fondo marino desde el espacio con los ojos de la inteligencia artificial*
-  **Science & Wine** (Blog). *Pierce’s disease of grapevines caused by Xylella fastidiosa: what are the risks?*

Outreach (continued)

Events

- 2024  **Pint of Science** (IFISC, UIB). *Descifrando el fondo marino desde el espacio*
- 2023  **IV Scientific Dissemination Contest** (UIB). *Desxifrant el fons marí des de l'espai amb els ulls de la intel·ligència artificial*
-  **Ciència a tot Tren** (CSIC). *Desxifrant el fons marí des de l'espai amb els ulls de la intel·ligència artificial*

Academic service

Peer-review

-  **Journals:** *PLoS Computational Biology, Conservation Biology, Scientific Reports, Ecological Modelling, Journal of Complex Networks*
-  **Conferences:** *Julia Conference.*

R&D organization

- 2022  Collaborator in the Conference of Complex Systems organization in Palma de Mallorca.

Other

- 2023  11F initiative collaborator since the 2023/24 edition. Webpage: <https://11defebrero.org/>

Honors & awards

- 2024  **Finalist of the IV Scientific Dissemination Contest of the UIB.**
- 2023  **Winner of the Circular Innovation Hackathon** (Sampol).
- 2022  **Winner of the Circular Innovation Hackathon** (Senda Ecoway).
-  **Top 5 poster competition EFSA.**

Skills

Coding	 Python, Julia, R, C++, bash, $\LaTeX$, ...
AI	 Deep Learning (e.g., RNN, LSTM, CNN), scikit-learn, ...
Databases	 MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite.
Web Dev	 Dash, jekyll, HTML, Markdown.
V. Control	 GIT
Geo data	 GEOjson, shapefile, geotiff
Climate data	 netCDF, GRIB
Tabular and other data	 CSV, Excel, JSON
Languages	 English, Spanish, Catalan.

Miscellaneous Experience

Developed webpages

-  **CAMELE dashboard** – <https://camele.ifisc.uib-csic.es/>

Miscellaneous Experience (continued)

- **Philaenus spumarius** egg hatching prediction – <https://pseggs.ifisc.uib-csic.es/>
- **Pierce's disease risk dashboard** – <https://pdrisk.ifisc.uib-csic.es/>
- **Personal webpage** – <https://agimenezromero.github.io>

Certifications

- 2023 ■ **Ecology: Ecosystem Dynamics and Conservation** – American Museum of Natural History.
- 2021 ■ **Natural Language Processing Specialisation** – DeepLearning.AI.
4 courses: *Introduction to TensorFlow for Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, and Deep Learning*; *Convolutional Neural Networks in TensorFlow*; *Natural Language Processing in TensorFlow*; *Sequences, Time Series and Prediction*
- **Tensorflow Developer** – DeepLearning.AI.
4 courses: *Natural Language Processing with Classification and Vector Spaces*; *Natural Language Processing with Probabilistic Models*; *Natural Language Processing with Sequence Models*; *Natural Language Processing with Attention Models*
- 2020 ■ **Scalable Machine Learning on Big Data using Apache Spark** – IBM.
- **Machine Learning with Python** – IBM.
- **The Data Science Course 2020: Complete Data Science Bootcamp** – Udemy.
- 2019 ■ **Fundamentals of Data Visualisation in Tableau** – Udemy.